

BM3 — Lesson 3: The Centurion

Faith That Commands Results



Theme: Trusting Jesus' Word



Background Text: Matt 8:5–13; Luke 7:1–10



Key Verse: Matt 8:10 (WEB)

“When Jesus heard it, he marveled, and said... ‘Most certainly I tell you, I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel.’”



Faith that trusts the Word, not the circumstances.



Appetizer – The Power of the Word, Matt 8:5–8

⁵ When he came into Capernaum, a centurion came to him, asking him for help, ⁶ saying, “Lord, my servant lies in the house paralyzed, grievously tormented.” ⁷ Jesus said to him, “**I will come and heal him.**” The centurion answered, ‘Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed.’

The centurion didn’t ask Jesus for a visit—he asked Him for a word. He believed that one word from Jesus could travel farther and work faster than any doctor, medicine, or ritual.

Faith is not about proximity—it’s about posture. The centurion knew Jesus didn’t have to be physically present to be powerfully effective. True belief doesn’t demand evidence; it simply trusts the Word.



Reflection Question

Have you ever believed God for something without needing to “see” how He would do it?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Faith That Understands Authority Matt 8:8–9a

The centurion answered, “Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed. For I also am a man under authority, having under myself soldiers. I tell this one, ‘Go,’ and he goes...”

He didn’t need Jesus to walk to his house. He understood that if Jesus had authority, then His word was enough—even from a distance. Real faith doesn’t always need a physical sign. It trusts that when Jesus speaks, it’s already done.

CST Thought

Humility is the bridge to divine help. The centurion had status, money, and influence—but he laid all of that down at Jesus’ feet. Faith is strongest when pride is silent.

Reflection Question

How does humility open the door for faith to operate in your life?

Bite 2 – Faith That Amazed Jesus, Matt 8:10, 13

¹⁰ When Jesus heard it, he marveled and said to those who followed, “Most certainly I tell you, I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel. ¹³ Jesus said to the centurion, “Go your way. Let it be done for you as you have believed.” His servant was healed in that hour.

When he looked at Jesus, he recognized heavenly authority at work: the same power that governs sickness, distance, and timing. Jesus was amazed at this man’s faith. Not because he was perfect or religious, but because he believed Jesus’ word was enough.

Author’s Commentary

Your background doesn’t limit your faith. Jesus is moved by trust, not titles. Aligning with the Great “I AM” starts with your words. Think about it: in the very first chapter of the Bible, the Creator didn’t use hands or tools to build the universe—He spoke ten times, and reality shifted.

Proverbs 18:21 tells us that life and death are held in the power of the tongue, and Isaiah 55:11 explains the authority behind that release. The Centurion understood the assignment. He knew that while "laying on of hands" might make people feel better, the real work happens when a word is released. He didn't need a ritual; he just needed a command. That word ricochets through eternity until it hits the target.

In the modern world, we say "Say Less"—because when you are walking in strong faith, you don't need a long speech. That level of trust was the "IT" factor that turned his request into a power move.

He believed that if Jesus spoke, creation itself had to respond. He saw that Jesus carried a higher command than Rome—kingdom authority.

Reflection Question

When you pray, do you believe the words you speak *in Jesus' name* carry that same delegated authority?

Bite 3 – The Sent Word, John 1:1,14

1 In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ¹⁴ And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, (and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.

The centurion had many reasons why he didn't believe Jesus needed to physically come, but Emmanuel, was happy someone caught the revelation. When he sent the word, he sent HIMSELF, because he was and is the Word! Whew...

He sent grace, and the truth that he was a healer, and a provider. In the past we use to send notes or mail by men on horseback, or by train... Now we have devices that allow us to send our thoughts via recorded files or text across oceans and time zones. They did not have electricity and the internet but they had faith and the Son of God walking with them...who was God's word wrapped in clay. Since he is wholeness and healing ...he just released it with his servant's recovery in mind... and in an hour he was well again!

Reflection Question

Who could you be praying for or believing for, like the centurion did for his servant?

Dessert – Beyond a Resume - A Word Is Enough

Jesus didn't respond to the wealth, the power, or the "good guy" resume. He responded to a heart in need. Emmanuel—God with us—met a level of faith that understood Christ's authority isn't limited by physical presence. The Centurion knew that the Will and the Word of God were enough to cross any threshold and restore what was broken.

When we say "Amen," we are literally saying **"It is so."** It's the moment we stop looking for a physical sign and come into total agreement with what God has already spoken. The Centurion didn't need a visit; he just needed a Word. He knew that once the Word was released, the shift was already final.

What would shift in your prayer life if you trusted what God said more than what you see?

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight together teach us that authority in prayer isn't about volume or visibility—it's about confidence in the Word of God.
 - Humility positions us to receive what pride would block.
 - Real faith does not require God to "prove it" first; it rests in what He has already spoken.
 - When you recognize Jesus' authority, you can walk in your own God-given authority with boldness and peace.
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Prayer

"Lord Jesus, thank You for the centurion's example of simple, strong faith. Help me to trust Your Word more than what I see and to pray with confidence in Your authority, not my own strength. Teach me to stay humble, to believe that when You speak, things change. In Your name, amen."



Word Study

- **Centurion (Latin: *Centurio*)** – A Roman officer over about one hundred soldiers; represents leadership through discipline, obedience, and order.
- **Authority (Greek: *Exousia*, ἐξουσία)** – Permission and delegated power; the right to act. Jesus carries authority over nature, sickness, sin, and even death.
- **Faith (Greek: *Pistis*, πίστις)** – Trust, conviction, and complete reliance upon God’s truth and character.

Write a short line about where you need to trust Jesus’ authority more fully:



Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion’s faith worked even at a _____.
2. Jesus said, “I have not found anyone in Israel with such great _____.”
3. True faith doesn’t need evidence; it trusts the _____.
4. The centurion understood the power of _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Appendix – Breakfast Month 3 (AE) Answer Key

Theme: Faith & Foresight – Youth Edition

Lesson 1 – Rahab: Faith That Took Action

Activity – True or False: Rahab’s Faith

1. Rahab was an Israelite woman raised in a godly home.
➤ False – She was a Canaanite woman from Jericho.
2. The scarlet rope was a sign of the agreement between Rahab and the spies.
➤ True
3. Rahab’s actions showed both faith in God and concern for her family.
➤ True
4. Rahab’s faith only affected her, not anyone else.
➤ False – Her whole household was saved.
5. Rahab is later mentioned in the family line of Jesus.
➤ True – She appears in His genealogy.

Lesson 2 – Abigail: Wisdom on the Move

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with **wisdom** and faith, not fear.
 2. Nabal’s pride led to his **death**.
 3. David praised God for Abigail’s **good sense/wisdom**.
 4. Abigail’s wisdom prevented **bloodshed/killing** and brought peace.
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Lesson 3 – The Centurion: Faith That Commands Results

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion's faith worked even at a distance.
 2. Jesus said, "I have not found anyone in Israel with such great faith."
 3. True faith doesn't need evidence; it trusts the Word.
 4. The centurion understood the power of authority.
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Lesson 4 – Joseph of Arimathea: Trust the Process

Activity – Connect the Process

Match each act of faith with the correct result:

- 1 Joseph's request for Jesus' body → **Jesus' body was placed in a tomb of honor.**
- 2 Building his own tomb → **God used a personal plan for divine purpose.**
- 3 Wrapping Jesus in linen → **The burial fulfilled prophecy with reverence.**
- 4 Rolling the stone → **A temporary seal that set up resurrection power.**